



Bond Feasibility Survey

Summary Report

Prepared for Colorado Springs School District 11

Prepared by Fog Signal Strategies

March 2026



TABLE OF CONTENTS

INTRODUCTION	3
KEY FINDINGS	6
IMPORTANCE OF ISSUES.....	9
INITIAL BALLOT TEST.....	11
QUALITY OF EDUCATION	15
PROJECTS & IMPROVEMENTS	17
POSITIVE ARGUMENTS	20
INTERIM BALLOT TEST	22
NEGATIVE ARGUMENTS.....	24
FINAL BALLOT TEST.....	26
CHANGE IN SUPPORT	27
BACKGROUND & DEMOGRAPHICS	28
METHODOLOGY	31
QUESTIONNAIRE & TOPLINES	32



INTRODUCTION

Serving the communities of Colorado Springs, Colorado Springs School District No. 11 is the largest school district in the Pikes Peak region and the sixth-largest in Colorado. The District encompasses 58 schools—including 34 elementary schools, eight middle schools, four comprehensive high schools (Coronado, Doherty, Mitchell, and Palmer), and several alternative and charter programs—serving approximately 22,265 students across a 147-square-mile attendance area in central Colorado Springs and surrounding communities in El Paso County.

Colorado Springs School District 11 has not successfully passed a bond measure in more than two decades. In November 2021, the District placed a \$350 million bond measure (Ballot Issue 4B) before voters to begin addressing an estimated \$700 million maintenance backlog across its aging school facilities. The measure came within just 11 votes of passing after an automatic recount—with 27,476 ‘No’ votes to 27,465 ‘Yes’ votes—making it one of the closest school bond elections in Colorado history. Since that near-miss, the underlying facility needs that motivated the measure have only grown in the intervening years.

Most of the District’s school buildings were constructed more than 60 years ago and are in urgent need of repair and modernization. Deteriorating roofs, aging plumbing and electrical systems, outdated HVAC systems that leave classrooms without reliable air conditioning, and the continued presence of hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes in older facilities present ongoing challenges. Additionally, aging portable classrooms with structural damage, water leaks, and mold remain in use at several campuses. To adequately address these needs and provide students with safe, modern learning environments, the District began exploring a new bond measure in 2025.

The District’s Facilities Master Plan, which calls for rebuilding, renovating, or repurposing dozens of schools and campuses, provides the foundation for the proposed \$750 million bond measure. The measure would fund the removal of hazardous materials, installation of modern heating, cooling, and air-filtration systems, renovation of four high schools (Doherty, Coronado, Mitchell, and Palmer) and upgrades to middle schools in each region, replacement of outdated portable classrooms, improvements to school safety and security, and updates to classrooms and labs for science, technology, and in-demand trades. All funds would remain local with independent oversight by a Citizens’ Committee and no money directed to administrator salaries.

MOTIVATION FOR RESEARCH

The primary purpose of this study was to produce an unbiased, statistically reliable evaluation of voters' interest in supporting a local bond measure to fund the construction, improvement, repair, and modernization of school facilities and classrooms noted above. Additionally, should the District decide to move forward with a bond measure, the survey data can guide how best to structure a measure so that it is consistent with the community's priorities and expressed needs. Specifically, the survey was designed to:

- Gauge current, baseline support for a local bond measure to fund improvements to school classrooms and facilities,
- Identify the types of projects that voters are most interested in funding, should the measure pass,
- Expose voters to arguments in favor of—and against—the proposed bond measure to gauge how information affects support for the measure, *and*
- Estimate support for the measure once voters are presented with the types of information they will likely be exposed to during the election cycle.

It is important to note at the outset that voters' opinions about tax measures are often somewhat fluid, especially when the amount of information they initially have about a measure is limited. How voters think and feel about a measure today may not be the same way they think and feel once they have had a chance to hear more information about the measure in the months leading up to election day. Accordingly, to accurately assess the feasibility of passing a bond measure, it was important that in addition to measuring current opinions about the measure, the survey expose respondents to the types of information voters are likely to encounter in future months—including arguments in favor of and opposed to the measure—and gauge how this information ultimately impacts their voting decision.

It is also important to note that Colorado's Taxpayer's Bill of Rights (TABOR) requires that bond measures include specific financial disclosures in the ballot language, including the total repayment cost and the maximum annual tax increase. For this measure, voters will see that the \$750 million bond carries a repayment cost not to exceed \$1.3 billion and would increase District taxes by up to \$55 million annually. Research consistently shows that the inclusion of total repayment cost in ballot language can depress initial support relative to states where such disclosure is not required. This context is important when interpreting the survey results.

OVERVIEW OF METHODOLOGY

For a full discussion of the research methods and techniques used in this study, turn to the Methodology section at the end of this report. In brief, the survey was administered to a random sample of 852 registered voters in Colorado Springs School District No. 11 who have a history of voting in midterm general elections (voted in either the 2022 or 2018 general election). The survey was administered via text-to-web and phone between February and March 2026. The survey instrument consisted of approximately 50 items across 9 questions and took an average of 12 minutes to complete.

ORGANIZATION OF REPORT

This report is designed to meet the needs of readers who prefer a summary of the findings as well as those who are interested in the details of the results. For those who seek an overview of the findings, the section titled Key Findings is for you. It provides a summary of the most important findings of the survey and a discussion of their implications. For the interested reader, this section is followed by a more detailed question-by-question discussion of the results from the survey by topic area (see Table of Contents), as well as a description of the methodology employed for collecting and analyzing the data. And, for the truly ambitious reader, the questionnaire used for the interviews is contained at the back of this report and a complete set of crosstabulations for the survey results is contained in Appendix A.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Fog Signal Strategies thanks Colorado Springs School District No. 11 for the opportunity to assist the District in this important effort. The collective expertise, local knowledge, and insight provided by district staff and representatives improved the overall quality of the research presented here.

DISCLAIMER

The statements and conclusions in this report are those of the author (Carter James) at Fog Signal Strategies and not necessarily those of the District. Any errors and omissions are the responsibility of the author.



KEY FINDINGS

As noted in the Introduction, this study was designed to provide Colorado Springs School District No. 11 with a statistically reliable understanding of voters' interest in funding the construction, improvement, and repair of school classrooms and facilities with a local bond measure. Whereas subsequent sections of this report are devoted to conveying the detailed results of the survey, in this section we attempt to 'see the forest for the trees' and note how the collective results of the survey answer some of the key questions that motivated the research. The following conclusions are based on Fog Signal Strategies' interpretations of the survey results and the firm's collective experience conducting revenue measure studies for public agencies throughout the State.

Does a bond measure appear feasible for the November 2026 ballot?

The results of this survey suggest that a \$750 million bond measure for Colorado Springs School District 11 is feasible and represents a stronger starting position than the 2021 measure. A well-executed campaign will be essential to convert this opportunity into a successful outcome. At the Initial Ballot Test, 58.5% of likely voters indicated they would vote yes on the proposed measure (31.0% Definitely Yes and 27.5% Probably Yes), compared to 31.3% who said they would vote no and 10.2% who were undecided. This initial level of support exceeds the 50%+1 simple majority threshold required under Colorado's TABOR for passage of a general obligation bond and represents a stronger starting position than the 2021 \$350M bond measure (Issue 4B), which failed by just 11 votes in a near-even 50/50 split. As expected in any bond feasibility study, voter support shifted when respondents were exposed to opposition messaging. After respondents heard both positive and negative arguments, support settled at 51.5% Yes while opposition grew to 37.6% No. Importantly, the measure still maintained majority support even after full exposure to opposition attacks. The "Definitely Yes" vote dropped from 31.0% to 25.8%, highlighting the segment of soft supporters who will benefit most from a proactive information campaign. On balance, the data indicate the measure starts from a solid foundation that, with the right campaign strategy, can be strengthened into a winning coalition.

How will the tax rate and TABOR disclosures affect support for the measure?

Colorado's TABOR requires the ballot to disclose the total repayment cost (\$1.3 billion) and the maximum annual tax increase (\$55 million). These disclosures are prominently featured in the ballot language presented to respondents. Despite this, 58.5% of voters initially supported the measure—suggesting that the disclosed costs did not, on their own, suppress support below the majority threshold. Notably, one of the positive arguments tested framed the annual cost as approximately \$348 per year for the average homeowner—less than a dollar a day. However, when opposition arguments highlighted the \$1.3 billion total repayment cost and characterized the annual tax burden as too much for working families and seniors, support softened. The opposition argument citing the total interest cost was found convincing by 64.7% of respondents, while the affordability argument citing inflation and timing resonated with 70.5%. These findings suggest that while the annualized framing can soften the sticker shock of TABOR disclosures, the District must be prepared to address the total repayment cost directly and credibly.

What projects do voters identify as priorities for a future bond?

Of the 13 projects and improvements tested, those related to health, safety, and basic building infrastructure received the strongest support. Improving HVAC and air quality systems (82.5% total favor), upgrading older schools to meet health and safety codes (82.2%), and repairing or replacing deteriorating roofs, plumbing, and electrical systems (81.7%) topped the list. Removing hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes (80.0%) and improving student safety and campus security (79.5%) also garnered strong support. These top priorities align closely with the emphasis in the proposed ballot language on hazmat removal, HVAC installation, safety improvements, and facility renovation. At the other end of the spectrum, resurfacing and repairing school parking lots received the least support at 61.5% total favor, followed by building or renovating facilities to support right-sizing the District at 67.7%.

How might a public information campaign affect support for the proposed measure?

The survey's sequential ballot design reveals that positive arguments reinforced existing support rather than expanding it—a pattern commonly observed in feasibility research, where voters who already support a measure tend to feel validated rather than shift categories, while opposition arguments produced the expected downward pressure on support. This asymmetry between positive and negative messaging is well-documented in public opinion research and is precisely why feasibility studies test opposition arguments—to identify vulnerabilities the District can prepare for in advance. From the Initial Ballot Test (58.5% Yes) to the Interim Ballot Test after positive arguments (58.6% Yes), support held essentially flat—a gain of just 0.1 percentage points. However, after exposure to opposition arguments, support fell to 51.5% Yes at the Final Ballot Test, a shift that is typical in bond feasibility studies where respondents are exposed to concentrated opposition messaging. The strongest positive arguments were student safety (67.3% total convincing), career and technical education (66.9%), and saving money long-term through facility upgrades (66.4%). The fiscally responsible plan with audits (54.7%) and right-sizing the district (54.9%) were less persuasive as standalone arguments, though both remain useful as supporting messages within a broader campaign narrative.

On the opposition side, board transparency about school closures (76.2%), financial mismanagement history (74.1%), no legally binding guarantee on spending (72.8%), and property tax burden on families and seniors (72.8%) were the most effective opposition messages tested. It is worth noting that negative arguments routinely outperform positive arguments in survey research—voters are naturally more responsive to perceived threats than to benefits—which is why proactive preparation is so valuable. The imbalance between positive and negative messaging effectiveness is a common finding in bond feasibility research and highlights the importance of a well-prepared campaign strategy. To overcome this imbalance, the District should pursue a dual-track approach: conducting its own factual public information campaign to educate voters on facility needs, project details, and built-in accountability measures, while also supporting the establishment of an independent campaign organization capable of advocating for passage and directly countering the misleading and exaggerated claims opponents are likely to deploy. Several of the most effective opposition arguments tested in this survey rely on distortions and emotional appeals rather than factual objections—suggesting that a well-prepared campaign can neutralize their impact. Continued community engagement through town halls, facility tours, and transparent communication about the District's needs will be essential to building and sustaining voter confidence through Election Day.

How might changes to the economic or political climate alter support for the measure?

A survey is a snapshot in time—which means the results of this study and the conclusions noted above must be viewed in light of the current economic and political climates. On the one hand, this should provide some reassurances to the District that a bond measure may be feasible. The 2021 measure came within 11 votes of passing, and the community has had four additional years to observe the continued deterioration of school facilities. On the other hand, the months leading up to the election are likely to be punctuated by significant events on the economic and political fronts. Concerns about inflation, interest rates, and housing affordability continue to weigh on voters in El Paso County. The potential presence of a competing public safety tax measure on the same ballot could create a perceived competition between funding schools and funding police, fire, and emergency services. Additionally, the broader political environment—including any hyper-partisan dynamics or shifts in voter turnout patterns—could influence the outcome. Should the economy improve and competing ballot measures be minimized, support for the measure could increase. Conversely, negative economic developments or a crowded ballot could create headwinds—but these are manageable risks that a well-prepared campaign can anticipate and address.



IMPORTANCE OF ISSUES

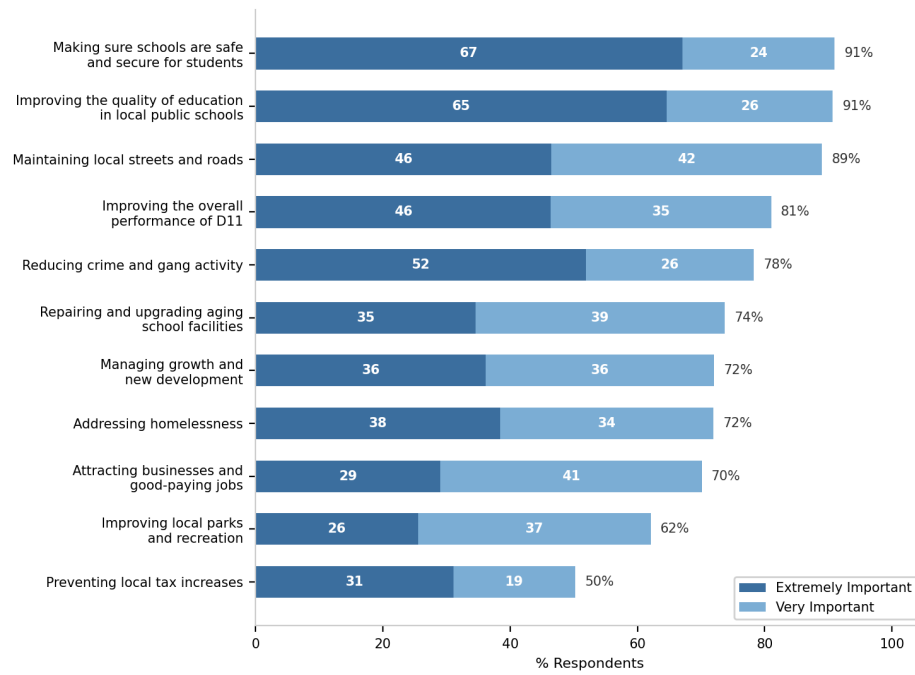
The first substantive question of the survey presented respondents with eleven issues facing residents in the District and asked them to rate the importance of each issue. Because the same response scale was used for each issue, the results provide an insight into how important each issue is on a scale of importance as well as how each issue ranks in importance relative to the other issues tested. To avoid a systematic position bias, the order in which the issues were presented was randomized for each respondent.

The eleven issues tested were: improving the quality of education in local public schools, repairing and upgrading aging school facilities, maintaining local streets and roads, preventing local tax increases, reducing crime and gang activity, attracting businesses and good-paying jobs, improving local parks and recreation, improving school safety and security, managing growth and new development, improving the overall performance of D11, and addressing homelessness.

As shown in Figure 1, making sure schools are safe and secure for students was rated as the most important issue, with 91.1% of respondents describing it as extremely or very important (67.1% extremely important). Improving the quality of education in local public schools ranked a close second at 90.6% combined importance. These two school-related issues topped the list, outranking non-school issues such as maintaining local streets and roads (89.0%), improving the overall performance of D11 (81.0%), and reducing crime and gang activity (78.3%). Repairing and upgrading aging school facilities—the core purpose of the proposed bond measure—was rated extremely or very important by 73.7% of respondents. Notably, preventing local tax increases ranked last among the eleven issues tested, with only 50.2% rating it as extremely or very important and 18.1% saying it was not at all important. While tax sensitivity is present in the electorate, it does not dominate community priorities—a finding that bodes well for the bond measure's prospects.

Question 1 *To begin, I'm going to read a list of issues facing our community. For each one, please tell me how important you feel the issue is to you — extremely important, very important, somewhat important, or not at all important.*

FIGURE 1 IMPORTANCE OF ISSUES



1. Issues were ranked based on the percentage of respondents who indicated that the issue was either extremely important or very important.

INITIAL BALLOT TEST

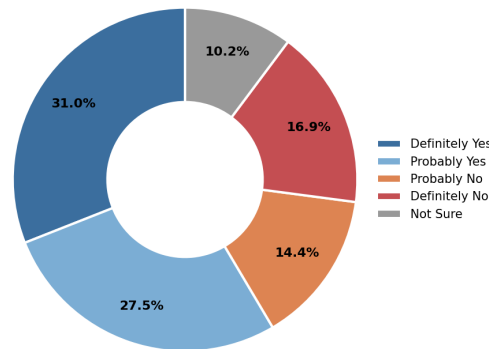
The primary research objective of this survey was to estimate voters' support for a bond measure that would raise up to \$750 million to remove hazardous materials including asbestos and lead pipes; install modern heating, cooling, and air-filtration systems; improve school and student safety and security; renovate Doherty, Coronado, Mitchell, and Palmer high schools and upgrade one middle school in each region, including replacing outdated portable classrooms; and update classrooms and labs for science, technology, and in-demand trades. To this end, Question 3 was designed to take an early assessment of support for the proposed measure.

The motivation for placing Question 3 near the front of the survey is twofold. First, voter support for a measure can often depend on the amount of information they have about a measure. At this point in the survey, the respondent has not been provided information about the proposed measure beyond what is presented in the ballot language. This situation is analogous to a voter casting a ballot with limited knowledge about the measure, such as what might occur in the absence of an effective education campaign. Question 3, also known as the Initial Ballot Test, is thus a good measure of voter support for the proposed measure as it is today, on the natural. Because the Initial Ballot Test provides a gauge of natural support for the measure, it also serves a second purpose in that it provides a useful baseline from which to judge the impact of various information items conveyed later in the survey on voter support for the measure.

It is worth noting that under Colorado's TABOR, the ballot language includes the total repayment cost of the bond (\$1.3 billion) and the maximum annual tax increase (\$55 million). This level of financial disclosure is more extensive than what voters in many other states encounter, and research has shown it can have a moderating effect on initial support. Accordingly, the Initial Ballot Test results should be interpreted with this context in mind.

Question 3 *Shall Colorado Springs School District No. 11 debt be increased \$750,000,000, with a repayment cost of not to exceed \$1.3 Billion, and shall District taxes be increased by not more than \$55,000,000 annually to pay such debt, all for the purpose of providing capital improvements for District purposes, including but not limited to: Removing hazardous materials, including asbestos and lead pipes; Installing modern heating, cooling, and air-filtration systems in District schools; Improving school and student safety and security; Renovating Doherty, Coronado, Mitchell, and Palmer high schools and upgrading one middle school in each region, including replacing outdated portable classrooms; Updating classrooms and labs for science, technology, and in-demand trades; The proposed measure would require independent oversight by a Citizens' Committee to ensure all funds stay local and are used only for voter-approved projects, with no money going to administrator salaries. If the election were held today, would you vote yes or no on this measure?*

FIGURE 2 INITIAL BALLOT TEST



As shown in Figure 2, 58.5% of respondents indicated they would vote yes on the proposed \$750 million bond measure (31.0% Definitely Yes and 27.5% Probably Yes), while 31.3% said they would vote no (16.9% Definitely No and 14.4% Probably No). An additional 10.2% were undecided. The initial level of support exceeds the 50%+1 simple majority required for passage and suggests a stronger starting position than the 2021 bond election, where the vote was essentially 50/50. However, the “Probably Yes” category at 27.5% represents a large bloc of soft supporters whose votes cannot be taken for granted—as subsequent ballot tests in this survey will demonstrate.

SUPPORT BY SUBGROUPS

Table 1 presents a demographic breakdown of initial support. Party affiliation showed notable variation: Unaffiliated voters were most supportive at 60.8% Yes, followed by Democrats at 56.9% and Republicans at 56.5%. By age, voters 50 to 64 were most supportive (60.4% Yes) while those 18 to 29 were least supportive (52.2%), followed closely by voters 40 to 49 (52.8%). Respondents with children currently in D11 schools (60.6% Yes) were slightly more supportive than those without (58.1%), though the gap was modest. Voters with children in private or charter schools were notably less supportive at 48.1% Yes. Gender differences were small, with women (59.6%) slightly more supportive than men (57.3%).

TABLE 1 DEMOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN OF SUPPORT AT INITIAL BALLOT TEST

	Approx. % of Voter Universe	% Probably or Definitely Yes	% Not Sure
Overall	100	58.5	10.2
District Child in Hsld — Yes, current (D11)	21	60.6	8.3
District Child in Hsld — No (D1)	79	58.1	10.6
Grown Children in D11 — Yes (D3)	48	57.3	12.1
Grown Children in D11 — No (D3)	51	59.8	8.2
Age: 18 to 29	3	52.2	0.0
Age: 30 to 39	14	60.3	7.8

	Approx. % of Voter Universe	% Probably or Definitely Yes	% Not Sure
Age: 40 to 49	17	52.8	11.1
Age: 50 to 64	32	60.4	10.5
Age: 65 or older	34	59.2	11.3
Party: Democrat	26	56.9	14.7
Party: Republican	30	56.5	8.7
Party: Unaffiliated / Other	44	60.8	8.6
Child in Private School — Yes (D2)	6	48.1	9.3
Child in Private School — No (D2)	93	59.3	10.2
Gender: Male	41	57.3	9.2
Gender: Female	48	59.6	10.2

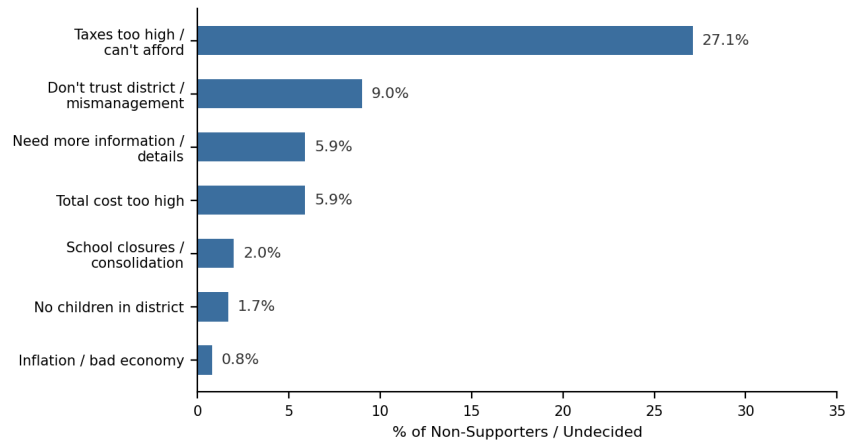
REASONS FOR NOT SUPPORTING MEASURE

Respondents who did not support or were unsure about the measure at the Initial Ballot Test were subsequently asked if there was a particular reason for their position. Question 4 was asked in an open-ended manner, allowing respondents to mention any reason that came to mind without being prompted by or restricted to a particular list of options. Fog Signal Strategies later reviewed the verbatim responses and grouped them into categories.

Among the 354 respondents who did not initially support or were unsure about the measure, the most frequently cited reason was that taxes are already too high or that voters cannot afford additional tax burden (27.1%). Distrust of the District or concerns about financial mismanagement were mentioned by 9.0% of respondents. Concerns about the total cost being too high (5.9%) and a desire for more specific details about how funds would be spent (5.9%) were also cited. A smaller share noted they have no children in the district (1.7%) or expressed concerns about school closures and consolidations (2.0%). A substantial portion of respondents (57.3%) provided responses that did not fit neatly into these categories or simply stated “no” without elaboration.

Question 4 *Is there a particular reason why you don’t support or are unsure about the school measure I just described?*

FIGURE 3 REASONS FOR NOT SUPPORTING MEASURE



QUALITY OF EDUCATION

To understand why voters take the positions they do with respect to a revenue measure, it is often instructive to look beyond the specifics of the measure itself. In particular, how voters perceive the quality of education being provided by the District can have a meaningful impact on their support for the proposed bond measure. Voters who view the District favorably are generally more willing to invest additional resources, while those who perceive the District as underperforming may be reluctant to approve new funding.

This question is particularly relevant for Colorado Springs School District 11, which has faced academic challenges in recent years and has undergone school closures and consolidations. One of the opposition arguments tested in this survey directly references the District's academic track record (Q8I), making it important to understand how voters perceive education quality as a baseline.

As shown in Figure 4, 39.3% of respondents rated the quality of education in District 11 positively—6.0% as excellent and 33.3% as good. Meanwhile, 29.1% rated it as fair, and 15.4% rated it negatively (9.2% poor and 6.2% very poor). A notable 16.2% were unsure or declined to offer a rating. The plurality “Good” rating at 33.3% and the large “Fair” category at 29.1% together suggest that most voters have a moderate but not enthusiastic view of education quality. Voters who rated education as excellent or good were significantly more likely to support the bond at the Initial Ballot Test, while those who rated it as poor or very poor were more likely to oppose the measure.

Question 2 *In general, how would you rate the quality of education provided in Colorado Springs School District 11? Would you say it is excellent, good, fair, poor, or very poor?*

FIGURE 4 QUALITY OF EDUCATION

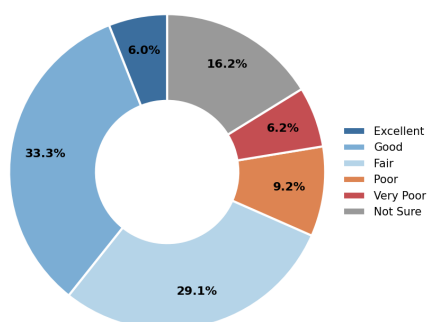
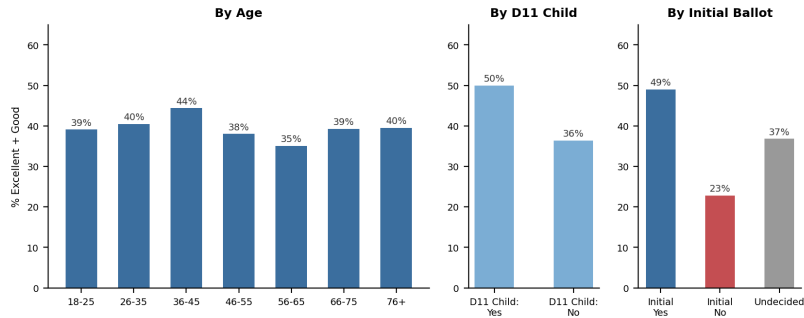


FIGURE 5 QUALITY OF EDUCATION BY AGE, DISTRICT CHILD IN HSLD & POSITION AT INITIAL BALLOT TEST



PROJECTS & IMPROVEMENTS

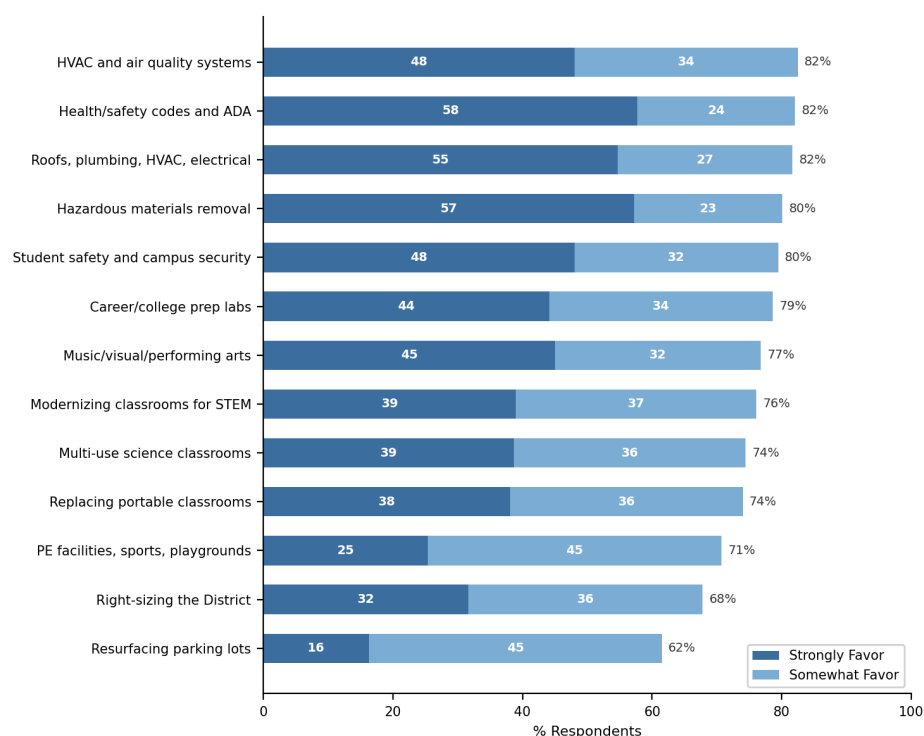
The ballot language presented in Question 3 indicated that the proposed bond measure would be used to remove hazardous materials; install modern heating, cooling, and air-filtration systems; improve school safety and security; renovate four high schools and upgrade middle schools; replace outdated portable classrooms; and update classrooms and labs for science, technology, and in-demand trades. The purpose of Question 5 was to provide respondents with the full range of 13 projects that may be funded by the proposed measure, as well as identify which of these improvements voters most favored funding with bond proceeds.

Question 5 *The measure we've been discussing would provide funding for a variety of school projects and improvements. If the measure passes, would you favor or oppose using some of the money to: _____, or do you not have an opinion?*

The 13 projects and improvements tested were:

- A.** Modernize classrooms, facilities, and technology for math, science, engineering, and technology instruction
- B.** Provide classrooms and facilities for music, visual, and performing arts instruction
- C.** Provide modern labs and equipment for college/career prep in health sciences, engineering, robotics, technology, and skilled trades
- D.** Improve student safety and campus security systems including cameras, emergency communications, locks, fencing, smoke detectors, fire alarms, and sprinklers
- E.** Repair or replace deteriorating roofs, plumbing, heating, cooling, ventilation, gas lines, sewer lines, and electrical systems
- F.** Upgrade older schools to meet health codes, building safety codes, and provide proper access for students with disabilities
- G.** Remove hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes from older school sites
- H.** Resurface and repair school parking lots to improve parent and student parking
- I.** Replace aging portable classrooms with modern, permanent classrooms
- J.** Upgrade and repair physical education facilities, sports fields, and playgrounds
- K.** Create modern, multi-use classrooms for hands-on science instruction
- L.** Improve heating, ventilation, air conditioning, and air quality systems to ensure healthy indoor environments
- M.** Build or renovate school facilities to support right-sizing of the District and reduce reliance on aging buildings

FIGURE 6 PROJECTS & IMPROVEMENTS



As shown in Figure 6, the five projects receiving the highest combined support were: improving HVAC and air quality systems (82.5% total favor), upgrading to meet health and safety codes (82.2%), repairing or replacing deteriorating roofs, plumbing, and electrical systems (81.7%), removing hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes (80.0%), and improving student safety and campus security (79.5%). Health, safety, and building infrastructure improvements consistently outperformed other categories. Three projects were favored by fewer than 70% of voters: resurfacing and repairing school parking lots (61.5%), building or renovating for right-sizing the District (67.7%), and upgrading PE facilities, sports fields, and playgrounds (70.7%).

PROJECT RATINGS BY INITIAL SUPPORT

Table 2 reveals a striking consensus across all voter groups on the top priorities for bond funds. Initial supporters, opponents, and undecided voters all ranked hazardous materials removal, health and safety code upgrades, and roof and infrastructure repairs among their top five priorities. This cross-partisan agreement on core building needs represents a strategic asset for the campaign. Among initial opponents, the percentage who strongly favored any project was markedly lower (25–31%) compared to supporters (59–74%), but the rank ordering of priorities was nearly identical—suggesting that even skeptical voters recognize the legitimacy of the District’s facility needs.

TABLE 2 TOP PROJECTS & IMPROVEMENTS BY POSITION AT INITIAL BALLOT TEST

Rank	Initial Supporters	Initial Opponents	Undecided
1	Health/safety codes — 74.1%	Hazmat removal — 30.7%	Hazmat removal — 57.5%
2	Hazmat removal — 71.3%	Roofs/plumbing/HVAC — 30.3%	Health/safety codes — 54.0%
3	Roofs/plumbing/HVAC — 69.1%	Health/safety codes — 28.5%	Roofs/plumbing/HVAC — 47.1%
4	HVAC/air quality — 62.2%	Safety/security — 27.0%	Safety/security — 44.8%
5	Safety/security — 59.8%	HVAC/air quality — 24.7%	Music/arts — 42.5%

POSITIVE ARGUMENTS

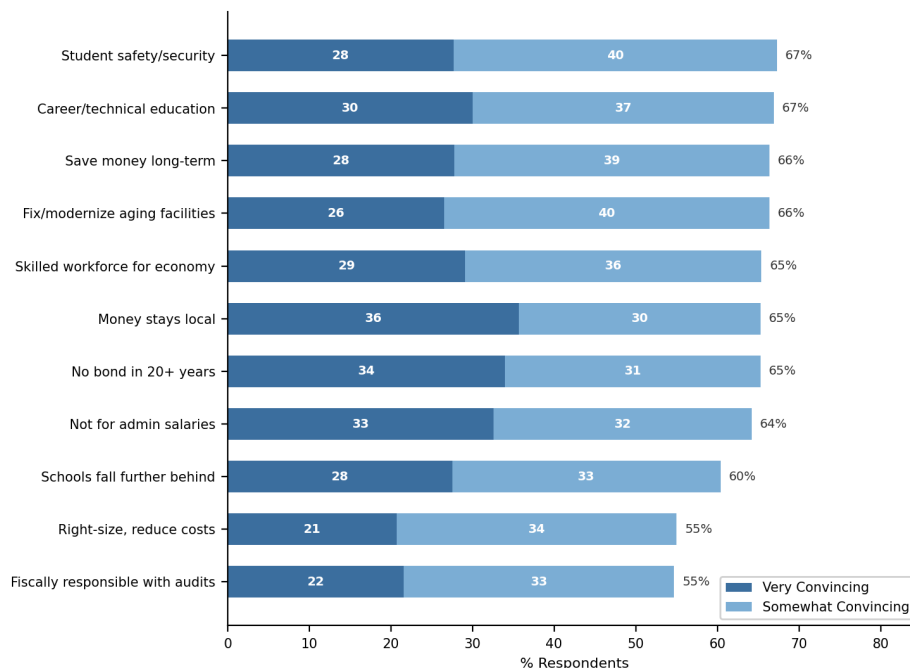
As noted in the body of this report, individuals' opinions about revenue measures are often not rigid, especially when the amount of information presented to the public on a measure has been limited. Thus, in addition to measuring current support for the measure, one of the goals of this study was to explore how the introduction of additional information about the measure may affect voters' opinions about the proposal.

Respondents were read a series of 12 statements that supporters of the measure might make and asked whether each statement was a very convincing, somewhat convincing, or not at all convincing reason to support the measure. The positive arguments tested and voter reactions are shown in Figure 7.

Question 6 *Supporters of the measure say: _____. Do you find this a very convincing, somewhat convincing, or not at all convincing reason to SUPPORT the measure?*

The 12 positive arguments tested were:

- A.** Student safety has become a top priority. This bond will fund increased safety and security measures to protect students and staff.
- B.** All money raised by the measure will stay local to support our students. It can't be taken away by the State or used for other purposes.
- C.** This measure requires transparent accountability, including a project list, a Citizens' Oversight Committee, and public disclosure of all spending.
- D.** By law, no money from this measure can be used for administrators' salaries or benefits.
- E.** Most of our schools were built more than 60 years ago. It's time to upgrade and repair them to serve our community for decades to come.
- F.** Most schools lack reliable air conditioning and ventilation, leading to hot classrooms and poor air quality. We need to fix these problems to ensure a healthy learning environment.
- G.** If we want our kids to succeed in college and careers, they must be skilled in today's technologies with a solid background in STEM.
- H.** Investing in our schools is an investment in our homes. Updated, modern school infrastructure is a key driver of stable property values and keeps our community a desirable place to live.
- I.** There are aging portable classrooms at our schools falling apart with structural damage, water leaks, and mold. We need to replace them.
- J.** Students today need hands-on training in skilled trades like welding, electrical, plumbing, and automotive repair. This measure builds modern career training facilities so graduates can enter high-paying jobs without taking on college debt.
- K.** For the average homeowner in the District, this bond would cost approximately \$348 per year — less than a dollar a day — to fund nearly \$750 million in school improvements across the community.
- L.** Right-sizing the District by consolidating underutilized schools will reduce operating costs and allow more money to be directed into classrooms and student programs rather than maintaining half-empty buildings.

FIGURE 7 POSITIVE ARGUMENTS

The three most convincing positive arguments were: student safety (67.3% total convincing), career and technical education (66.9%), and saving money long-term through facility upgrades (66.4%). Fix and modernize aging facilities (66.4%) and the skilled workforce argument (65.4%) also performed well. The least effective positive arguments were the fiscally responsible plan with audits (54.7%) and right-sizing the district to reduce operating costs (54.9%). The money stays local argument had the highest “Very Convincing” rate (35.7%) but a relatively low “Somewhat Convincing” rate, indicating it was polarizing—voters either found it compelling or dismissed it.

POSITIVE ARGUMENTS BY INITIAL SUPPORT

Among initial supporters, fix and modernize aging facilities (81.9% total convincing) and career/technical education (80.7%) were most persuasive. For initial opponents, student safety (48.3%) was the most convincing positive argument, followed by saving money long-term (46.1%) and the skilled workforce argument (43.8%). Among undecided voters, the skilled workforce for the economy (71.3%) and money stays local (65.5%) were most effective. These findings suggest that different messaging strategies may be needed for different audiences: safety and practical facility improvements resonate with opponents, while economic and workforce arguments are most effective with the undecided.

TABLE 3 TOP POSITIVE ARGUMENTS BY POSITION AT INITIAL BALLOT TEST

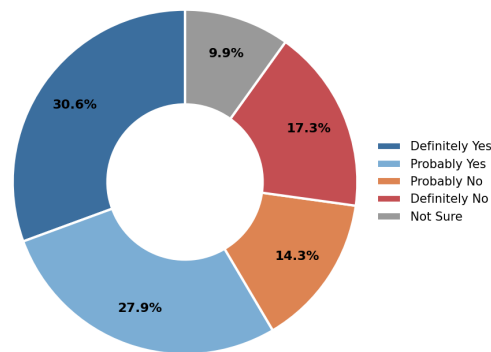
Rank	Initial Supporters	Initial Opponents	Undecided
1	Fix aging facilities — 81.9%	Student safety — 48.3%	Skilled workforce — 71.3%
2	Career/tech ed — 80.7%	Save money long-term — 46.1%	Money stays local — 65.5%
3	No bond 20+ years — 79.1%	Skilled workforce — 43.8%	Student safety — 64.4%

INTERIM BALLOT TEST

After being exposed to the series of 12 positive arguments in favor of the proposed bond measure, respondents were asked a second time whether they would vote yes or no on the measure. The purpose of this Interim Ballot Test (Question 7) was to gauge the impact that exposure to positive information about the measure had on voter support.

Question 7 *Shall Colorado Springs School District No. 11 debt be increased \$750 million, with a repayment cost not to exceed \$1.3 Billion, and shall District taxes be increased by not more than \$55 million annually to fund capital improvements at District schools — including removing hazardous materials, installing modern heating and cooling systems, improving school safety, renovating high schools and middle schools, replacing portable classrooms, and updating classrooms and labs — with independent oversight by a Citizens' Committee and no money going to administrator salaries?*

FIGURE 8 INTERIM BALLOT TEST



After being exposed to the series of 12 positive arguments, 58.6% of respondents said they would vote yes on the measure (30.6% Definitely Yes and 27.9% Probably Yes), compared to 31.6% who said no and 9.9% who were undecided. This represents virtually no change from the Initial Ballot Test (58.5% Yes), a net gain of just 0.1 percentage points. The stability of the overall number masks modest shifts within subgroups: Democrat support increased from 56.9% to 62.7% (+5.8 points), while Republican support actually declined from 56.5% to 53.0% (-3.5 points). The findings suggest that the positive arguments tested largely reinforced existing positions rather than persuading new voters to support the measure.

SUPPORT BY SUBGROUPS

TABLE 4 DEMOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN OF SUPPORT AT INTERIM BALLOT TEST

	Approx. % of Voter Universe	% Probably or Definitely Yes	% Not Sure
Overall	100	58.6	9.9
District Child — Yes, current	21	60.6	6.1
District Child — No	79	58.1	10.9
Age: 18 to 29	3	65.2	0.0
Age: 30 to 39	14	57.8	13.8
Age: 40 to 49	17	59.7	6.9
Age: 50 to 64	32	58.9	8.4
Age: 65 or older	34	57.9	11.6
Party: Democrat	26	62.7	12.9
Party: Republican	30	53.0	9.9
Party: Unaffiliated / Other	44	60.2	7.8
Gender: Male	41	58.2	9.2
Gender: Female	48	58.4	10.2

NEGATIVE ARGUMENTS

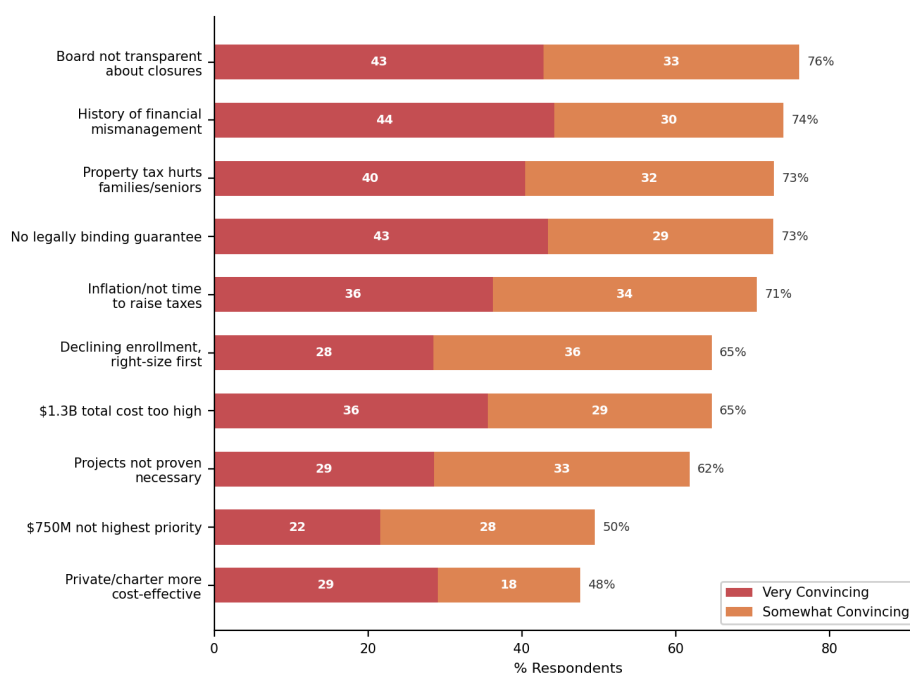
Just as the survey tested the impact of positive arguments on voter support, it also exposed respondents to a series of 13 negative arguments that opponents of the measure might make. This is standard practice in feasibility research—by stress-testing the measure against the strongest possible opposition messaging, the District gains a realistic understanding of where vulnerabilities exist and how to address them before Election Day. Respondents were asked whether each statement was a very convincing, somewhat convincing, or not at all convincing reason to oppose the measure.

Question 8 *Opponents of the measure say: _____. Do you find this a very convincing, somewhat convincing, or not at all convincing reason to OPPOSE the measure?*

The 13 negative arguments tested were:

- A.** Residents and businesses have been hit hard by inflation, high interest rates, and high gas prices. Now is not the time to raise taxes.
- B.** Our community is already expensive, especially for young families, seniors, and those on fixed incomes. This bond makes it less affordable.
- C.** Don't be fooled. Including interest, this bond will cost taxpayers more than \$1,229,284,247 and will take decades to pay off.
- D.** Residents are already paying too many taxes. There will also be new tax proposals on the ballot. We can't afford to keep raising taxes.
- E.** We can't trust the District with this tax. Like all government agencies, they will mismanage the money.
- F.** Property taxes in El Paso County have already gone up this year. Adding a new bond tax on top of higher property taxes is too much of a burden on homeowners.
- G.** The Colorado marijuana taxes are supposed to fund our schools. Voters shouldn't have to pay extra — the state should be taking care of this.
- H.** There is also a public safety measure on the ballot for El Paso County to fund police, fire, and emergency services. Voters shouldn't have to choose between funding schools and funding public safety, and both measures together are too much of a tax increase.
- I.** Colorado Springs School District 11 hasn't passed a bond measure in over 20 years and continues to face academic challenges. The District hasn't earned the public's trust and shouldn't be rewarded with a major tax increase.
- J.** The District has been closing and consolidating schools for years. Why should taxpayers invest \$750 million in buildings the District might shut down anyway?
- K.** There is no legally binding guarantee that bond funds will be spent as promised. The District could change priorities after the election, and voters would have no recourse.
- L.** Private and charter schools offer a more cost-effective alternative to expensive public school construction. Taxpayers shouldn't be forced to fund a system that isn't the only option.
- M.** A \$750 million bond is not the community's highest priority right now. There are more pressing needs like public safety, housing affordability, and infrastructure that should come first.

FIGURE 9 NEGATIVE ARGUMENTS



The five most convincing opposition arguments, all exceeding 64% total convincing, were: the school board has not been transparent about closure plans (76.2%), the District has a history of financial mismanagement (74.1%), there is no legally binding guarantee that funds will be spent as promised (72.8%), the bond will increase property taxes and hurt working families and seniors (72.8%), and inflation and high prices make now a bad time to raise taxes (70.5%). The two weakest opposition arguments were that private and charter schools are more cost-effective alternatives (47.7%) and that \$750 million is not the community’s highest priority (49.5%). These were the only opposition arguments that failed to reach majority convincing. The three most damaging arguments all center on trust and accountability—a theme the campaign must address proactively. It is important to note that several of the opposition arguments tested in this survey were intentionally designed to reflect the types of misleading or exaggerated claims that commonly circulate during school bond elections—including distortions legal requirements, unsubstantiated allegations of mismanagement, and emotionally charged framing intended to erode trust rather than inform voters. The effectiveness of these arguments, even among initial supporters, underscores the critical need for a two-pronged communication strategy: a District-led public information campaign that transparently educates voters on the condition of facilities, the scope of the proposed investments, and the safeguards built into the measure, paired with an established independent campaign committee that can advocate directly.

NEGATIVE ARGUMENTS BY INITIAL SUPPORT

TABLE 5 NEGATIVE ARGUMENTS BY POSITION AT INITIAL BALLOT TEST

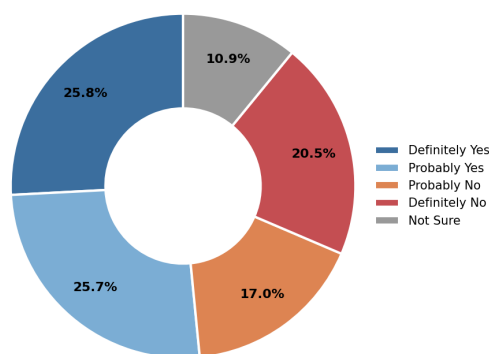
Rank	Initial Supporters	Initial Opponents	Undecided
1	Board not transparent — 71.9%	Property tax burden — 90.3%	Inflation/timing — 77.0%
2	Financial mismanagement — 67.1%	Financial mismanagement — 88.8%	Board not transparent — 74.7%
3	No binding guarantee — 66.7%	No binding guarantee — 86.5%	Financial mismanagement — 69.0%

FINAL BALLOT TEST

After being exposed to both positive and negative arguments about the proposed bond measure, respondents were asked a final time whether they would vote yes or no on the measure. The Final Ballot Test (Question 9) represents an estimate of voter support for the measure after respondents have been exposed to the types of information they will likely encounter during the election cycle.

Question 9 *Shall Colorado Springs School District No. 11 debt be increased \$750 million, with a repayment cost not to exceed \$1.3 Billion, and shall District taxes be increased by not more than \$55 million annually to fund capital improvements at District schools — including removing hazardous materials, installing modern heating and cooling systems, improving school safety, renovating high schools and middle schools, replacing portable classrooms, and updating classrooms and labs — with independent oversight by a Citizens’ Committee and no money going to administrator salaries? If the election were held today, would you vote yes or no on this measure?*

FIGURE 10 FINAL BALLOT TEST



At the Final Ballot Test, 51.5% of respondents said they would vote yes (25.8% Definitely Yes and 25.7% Probably Yes), while 37.6% said no (20.5% Definitely No and 17.0% Probably No) and 10.9% were undecided. Compared to the Initial Ballot Test, support moderated by 7.0 percentage points (from 58.5% to 51.5%), opposition grew by 6.3 points (from 31.3% to 37.6%), and the undecided share remained nearly constant. This pattern of support softening after exposure to opposition messaging is consistent with what is observed in virtually every bond feasibility study and does not, on its own, indicate the measure cannot succeed. The measure still clears the 50%+1 threshold at the Final Ballot Test, but the margin of just 1.5 points above the majority threshold reinforces that a well-organized campaign will be needed to secure passage—but the measure notably still commands majority support even in this worst-case simulation. The movement was concentrated among soft supporters—the very voters most reachable through a proactive information campaign: the “Definitely Yes” vote fell from 31.0% to 25.8%, while “Definitely No” grew from 16.9% to 20.5%. Given that the 2021 bond failed by just 11 votes, these findings underscore the opportunity before the District and the importance of a disciplined campaign effort.

CHANGE IN SUPPORT

One of the most informative aspects of this study is the ability to track how individual respondents' positions evolved over the course of the survey — from the Initial Ballot Test (before exposure to additional information) through the Final Ballot Test (after exposure to both positive and negative arguments).

As shown in Table 7, 74.1% of initial supporters held firm through the Final Ballot Test, while 16.7% moved to No and 9.2% became undecided. Among initial opponents, 77.9% remained opposed, 15.4% moved to Yes, and 6.7% became undecided. The undecided group split evenly: 33.3% moved to Yes, 33.3% moved to No, and 33.3% remained undecided. In net terms, the survey simulation shows a modest net shift of 42 voters from Yes to No over the full course of positive and negative messaging—a movement that a targeted campaign can realistically offset. Notably, 15.4% of initial opponents were persuaded to switch to Yes, demonstrating that even committed opposition is not immovable. The primary campaign challenge is clear: reinforcing the 26% of soft Yes voters who are reachable through a fact-based information campaign, while continuing to compete for the undecided voters who split evenly between the two sides. These findings reinforce the importance of a coordinated communication effort on two fronts: first, the District itself must conduct a robust public information campaign that transparently presents the facts about facility conditions, project priorities, and financial safeguards—giving voters the accurate foundation they need to make an informed decision. Second, an independent, well-organized campaign committee should be established to advocate for passage and deliver a consistent, fact-based message throughout the election cycle. Because much of the opposition messaging that proved effective in this survey relies on misleading characterizations and emotional appeals rather than factual accuracy, the campaign must be prepared to respond quickly and credibly to misinformation as it emerges. Equally important is sustained community engagement—through town halls, school tours, digital outreach, and neighborhood-level conversations—to build and maintain the broad-based coalition needed to carry the measure to victory.

TABLE 6 DEMOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN OF SUPPORT AT FINAL BALLOT TEST

	Approx. % of Voter Universe	% Probably or Definitely Yes	% Not Sure
Overall	100	51.5	10.9
District Child — Yes, current	21	47.2	11.7
District Child — No	79	52.7	10.7
Age: 18 to 29	3	43.5	4.3
Age: 65 or older	34	50.0	13.4
Party: Democrat	26	55.1	13.3
Party: Republican	30	47.4	7.5
Party: Unaffiliated / Other	44	52.2	11.8

TABLE 7 MOVEMENT BETWEEN INITIAL & FINAL BALLOT TEST

Position at Final Ballot Test	Initial Supporters	Initial Opponents	Initial Undecided
Definitely / Probably Yes	74.1%	15.4%	33.3%
Definitely / Probably No	16.7%	77.9%	33.3%
Not Sure / Prefer Not to Answer	9.2%	6.7%	33.3%

BACKGROUND & DEMOGRAPHICS

The following table presents the demographic characteristics of the survey sample.

TABLE 8 DEMOGRAPHICS OF SAMPLE

Demographic	Category	Approximate % of Sample
District Child in D11 (D1)	Yes	21.2
	No	78.8
Child in Private School (D2)	Yes	6.4
	No	93.6
Grown Children in D11 (D3)	Yes	48.5
	No	51.5
Age	18 to 29	2.7
	30 to 39	13.6
	40 to 49	16.9
	50 to 64	32.3
	65 or older	34.4
Party	Democrat	26.5
	Republican	29.8
	Unaffiliated / Other	43.7
Gender	Male	45.8
	Female	54.2

COMPARISON TO PREVIOUS POLLING

In June 2025, Cygnal conducted a benchmark survey of 400 likely voters in Colorado Springs School District No. 11 ($\pm 4.88\%$ margin of error) to gauge initial attitudes toward a potential bond measure. The current Fog Signal Strategies survey, fielded in 2026 with 852 respondents ($\pm 3.4\%$ margin of error), provides a substantially larger and more precise dataset for comparison. Taken together, the two surveys paint a picture of a community whose support for the bond measure has strengthened over time—a positive trajectory that is common in bond campaigns as voters become more familiar with the proposed projects and their benefits.

INITIAL BALLOT SUPPORT HAS INCREASED

The most directly comparable result from the Cygnal survey is the \$750 million long-ballot version (“Version B”), which mirrors the bond amount tested in the current survey. In June 2025, Cygnal found 54.3% of respondents in favor of Version B, with 29.0% opposed and 16.7% unsure. By comparison, the current Fog Signal survey shows 58.5% voting Yes on the Initial Ballot Test, 31.3% voting No, and just 10.2% Undecided. This represents a meaningful increase of more than four percentage points in initial support, while the share of undecided voters has also decreased—an indicator that the community is becoming more engaged and informed about the measure.

Cygnal also tested a plain-language version at a \$29 per month tax impact (comparable to the current measure’s scope), which yielded 44.5% in favor and 41.4% opposed—a much tighter margin. The current survey’s stronger initial showing suggests that the District’s ongoing community engagement and facility-condition messaging have been effective in building public understanding and support since the benchmark was established.

SUPPORT REMAINS RESILIENT AFTER OPPOSITION MESSAGING

In the Cygnal survey, support for the \$750M Version B dropped from 54.3% to approximately 50% after respondents were exposed to opposition messaging—a decline of roughly four points, with opposition rising from 29.0% to 33.0%. In the current Fog Signal survey, the Final Ballot Test shows 51.5% Yes and 37.6% No after a full battery of both positive and negative arguments. The measure maintains majority support throughout, and the current survey’s larger sample provides substantially greater confidence in these results.

It is also worth noting that the degree of movement from initial to final ballot is consistent across both surveys—a decline of roughly four to seven points, depending on the version and format. This pattern is entirely typical of bond feasibility research and reflects the designed purpose of the survey instrument, which deliberately exposes respondents to the strongest available opposition arguments to stress-test support. The fact that majority support holds through this process in both surveys is an encouraging indicator of the measure’s underlying viability.

MESSAGING THEMES REMAIN CONSISTENT

Both surveys confirm that infrastructure needs, modern learning environments, and student safety resonate most powerfully with voters. In the Cygnal survey, the “Infrastructure” message generated the highest raw support among all nine messaging themes tested, with 57.0% of respondents saying it made them more likely to support the bond, while “Security and Technology” and “Modern Learning Environments” also ranked among the most effective messages overall. The current survey echoes this finding, with facility conditions and safety upgrades consistently ranking among the top motivators. This consistency across two independent surveys conducted nearly a year apart provides strong

validation that the District's core message—centered on aging facilities and the need for safe, modern learning environments—resonates with the community and should anchor both the District's public information campaign and any independent advocacy effort.

STATISTICAL CONFIDENCE HAS IMPROVED

The current survey's sample of 852 respondents is more than double the Cygnal benchmark sample of 400, yielding a margin of error of $\pm 3.4\%$ compared to $\pm 4.88\%$. This means the current findings provide a significantly more precise and reliable snapshot of voter sentiment. The improvement in statistical confidence is especially important when evaluating close results: the current survey's tighter margin of error provides greater assurance that the observed majority support reflects the true state of public opinion in the District.

SUMMARY OF COMPARISON

Metric	Cygnal (June 2025)	Fog Signal (2026)
Sample Size	400	852
Margin of Error	$\pm 4.88\%$	$\pm 3.4\%$
Initial Support (Yes)	54.3%	58.5%
Initial Opposition (No)	29.0%	31.3%
Undecided	16.7%	10.2%
Post-Messaging Support (Yes)	~50%	51.5%
Post-Messaging Opposition (No)	~33%	37.6%

Across every key metric, the current survey confirms that the bond measure is in a stronger position today than when the Cygnal benchmark was established in June 2025. Initial support is higher, the undecided pool is smaller, majority support holds through opposition messaging, and the results are backed by a substantially larger and more statistically precise sample. These trends are consistent with what is typically observed in successful bond campaigns as community awareness and engagement increase over time. The data strongly support continuing to move forward with the bond measure and investing in a coordinated communication strategy to maintain and build upon this momentum.

METHODOLOGY

QUESTIONNAIRE DEVELOPMENT

The survey questionnaire was developed collaboratively by Fog Signal Strategies and representatives of Colorado Springs School District No. 11. The questionnaire was designed to capture voters' opinions on the key issues under investigation while maintaining objectivity and avoiding bias. The instrument included 9 substantive questions organized into topical sections covering issue importance, quality of education, three ballot tests (initial, interim, and final), project preferences, positive and negative arguments, and background demographics. All attitudinal questions used balanced scales with both positive and negative response options presented to respondents.

PROGRAMMING & PRE-TEST

The questionnaire was programmed for both online (text-to-web) and telephone administration using a professional survey platform. Prior to the main data collection effort, a pre-test was conducted with a small sample of respondents to identify any issues with question wording, skip logic, or survey flow. Minor revisions to question order and response option formatting were made based on pre-test feedback.

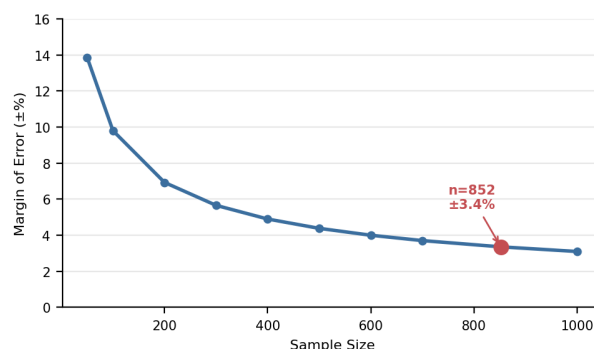
SAMPLE

The sample for the survey consisted of 852 registered voters in Colorado Springs School District No. 11 who have a history of voting in midterm general elections (voted in either the 2022 or 2018 general election). The sample was drawn from the voter file maintained by the El Paso County Clerk and Recorder. Post-stratification weights were applied by age group to align the sample with the midterm likely voter universe demographics.

STATISTICAL MARGIN OF ERROR

The overall statistical margin of error for the survey is approximately ± 3.4 percentage points at the 95% confidence level. This means that in 95 out of 100 cases, the results obtained from the survey would fall within ± 3.4 percentage points of the results that would be obtained if every eligible voter in the District were surveyed. Margins of error for subgroups will be larger.

FIGURE 11 MAXIMUM MARGIN OF ERROR DUE TO SAMPLING



RECRUITING & DATA COLLECTION

The survey was administered via text-to-web and phone between February and March 2026. The average interview lasted approximately 12 minutes. Post-stratification weights were applied by age group to ensure the sample was representative of the midterm likely voter universe in Colorado Springs School District 11.

DATA PROCESSING

Data processing included cleaning and validation of all responses, removal of incomplete or duplicate records, and coding of open-ended responses to Question 4 into thematic categories. Post-stratification weights were applied by age group to align the sample distribution with the midterm likely voter universe demographics in the District. Due to rounding, percentages may not sum to exactly 100%.

ROUNDING

Due to rounding, totals shown in charts and tables throughout this report may not sum to exactly 100%.

QUESTIONNAIRE & TOPLINES

The full questionnaire used for this study is reproduced on the following pages with topline results (i.e., the percentage of respondents who selected each response option) inserted alongside each question.

Note: The complete questionnaire with topline results is available in the accompanying appendix.



Colorado Springs School District 11

Community Baseline Survey

Topline Results

Prepared for: Colorado Springs School District 11

Prepared by: Fog Signal Strategies

March 2026

Methodology

This survey was conducted by Fog Signal Strategies on behalf of Colorado Springs School District 11 between February and March 2026. The survey was administered via text-to-web and phone among 852 registered voters in the District 11 boundary who have a history of voting in midterm general elections (voted in either the 2022 or 2018 general election). The survey instrument consisted of approximately 50 questions and took an average of 12 minutes to complete.

The sample of $n=852$ yields a margin of error of approximately $\pm 3.4\%$ at the 95% confidence level for the full sample. Margins of error for subgroups will be wider. Post-stratification weights were applied by age group to align the sample with the midterm likely voter universe demographics.

Results are reported as percentages. Due to rounding, percentages may not sum to exactly 100%.

Section 1: Community Issue Importance

Respondents were asked to rate the importance of various community issues on a four-point scale. Issues are ranked by combined "Extremely" and "Very Important" responses. (n=852)

Issue	Extremely Important	Very Important	Combined Imp.	Not At All Important
Making sure schools are safe and secure for students	67.1%	23.9%	91.1%	1.5%
Improving the quality of education in local public s...	64.5%	26.0%	90.6%	2.9%
Maintaining local streets and roads	46.4%	42.6%	89.0%	1.1%
Improving the overall performance of Colorado Spring...	46.4%	34.5%	81.0%	3.6%
Reducing crime and gang activity	51.8%	26.5%	78.3%	4.7%
Repairing and upgrading aging school facilities	34.7%	39.0%	73.7%	3.2%
Managing growth and new development	36.1%	35.8%	71.9%	5.4%
Addressing homelessness	38.3%	33.5%	71.8%	4.0%
Attracting businesses and good-paying jobs	28.9%	41.1%	70.0%	5.5%
Improving local parks and recreation	25.4%	36.7%	62.1%	4.0%
Preventing local tax increases	31.0%	19.1%	50.2%	18.1%

Key Finding: Making sure schools are safe and secure for students (91.1%) and improving the quality of education in local public schools (90.6%) top community concerns, closely followed by maintaining local streets and roads (89.0%). Preventing local tax increases ranks at 50.2%, indicating a notable tax-sensitive segment of the electorate.

Section 2: Quality of Education in District 11

Respondents were asked to rate the overall quality of education in Colorado Springs School District 11. (n=852)

Rating	Percent
Excellent	6.0%
Good	33.3%
Fair	29.1%
Poor	9.2%
Very Poor	6.2%
Not Sure	16.2%
NET Positive (Excellent + Good)	39.3%
NET Negative (Poor + Very Poor)	15.4%

Key Finding: Only 39.3% rate education quality positively, while 15.4% rate it negatively. A notable 16.2% are unsure, and the plurality rating is "Good" at 33.3%. The "Fair" category at 29.1% represents a large persuadable middle.

Section 3: Bond Measure Ballot Tests

The survey tested voter support for the proposed \$750 million school bond at three points: an initial ballot, after hearing support arguments, and a final ballot after hearing both support and opposition arguments. (n=852)

Response	Initial Ballot	After Support Arguments	Final Ballot
Definitely Yes	31.0%	30.6%	25.8%
Probably Yes	27.5%	27.9%	25.7%
TOTAL YES	58.5%	58.6%	51.5%
Not Sure	10.2%	9.9%	10.9%
Probably No	14.4%	14.3%	17.0%
Definitely No	16.9%	17.2%	20.5%
TOTAL NO	31.3%	31.6%	37.6%

Key Finding: The bond measure starts with majority support at 58.5% Yes but erodes to 51.5% Yes after voters hear opposition arguments — a 7.0-point decline. Support arguments have minimal impact on the overall number, while opposition arguments move the needle significantly. The "Definitely Yes" vote drops from 31.0% to 25.8%, indicating soft support vulnerable to opposition messaging.

Section 4: Vote Movement Analysis

Among the 852 respondents who completed all three ballot tests, the following table shows how initial votes translated to final votes after exposure to both support and opposition arguments.

Initial Vote →	Final: Yes	Final: Undecided	Final: No
Started Yes	369 (74.1%)	46 (9.2%)	83 (16.7%)
Started Undecided	29 (33.3%)	29 (33.3%)	29 (33.3%)
Started No	41 (15.4%)	18 (6.7%)	209 (77.9%)

Key Finding: 74.1% of initial Yes voters held firm, but 26% softened to Undecided or flipped to No. Among initial Undecided voters, 33.3% moved to Yes — a positive sign. However, No voters are highly locked in at 77.9% retention. The primary campaign challenge is hardening soft Yes voters against opposition messaging.

Section 5: Bond Fund Uses

Respondents were asked to rate their level of support for potential uses of bond funds. Items are ranked by total favor. (n=852)

Bond Use	Strongly Favor	Somewhat Favor	Total Favor	Total Oppose	Not Sure
Improving heating, ventilation, air conditioning...	47.9%	34.5%	82.5%	11.2%	6.2%
Upgrading older schools to meet health codes, b...	57.6%	24.5%	82.2%	11.6%	6.2%
Repairing or replacing deteriorating roofs, plu...	54.7%	26.9%	81.7%	10.9%	7.4%
Removing hazardous materials like asbestos and ...	57.1%	22.8%	80.0%	11.7%	8.2%
Improving student safety and campus security sy...	47.9%	31.5%	79.5%	13.8%	6.7%
Providing modern labs and equipment for college...	44.0%	34.4%	78.5%	14.4%	7.0%
Providing classrooms and facilities for music, ...	45.0%	31.7%	76.7%	16.4%	6.8%
Modernizing classrooms, facilities, and technol...	38.9%	37.1%	76.0%	17.2%	6.7%
Creating modern, multi-use classrooms for hands...	38.8%	35.6%	74.4%	16.5%	9.0%
Replacing aging portable classrooms with modern...	38.1%	35.9%	74.0%	16.0%	9.8%
Upgrading and repairing physical education faci...	25.4%	45.2%	70.7%	22.2%	7.0%
Building or renovating school facilities to sup...	31.6%	36.1%	67.7%	20.4%	11.8%
Resurfacing and repairing school parking lots t...	16.3%	45.2%	61.5%	29.5%	8.9%

Key Finding: Improving heating, ventilation, air conditioning, and air qu (82.5%), upgrading older schools to meet health codes, building safet (82.2%), and repairing or replacing deteriorating roofs, plumbing, heatin (81.7%) receive the strongest support. Resurfacing and repairing school parking lots to improve parent and student parking (61.5%) receives the least support. Health, safety, and building infrastructure items consistently outperform other categories.

Section 6: Support Argument Testing

Respondents were read a series of arguments in favor of the bond measure and asked how convincing each was. Arguments are ranked by total convincing. (n=852)

1. *“Student safety has become a top priority. This bond will fund increased safety and security measures to protect students and staff.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
27.8%	39.5%	67.3%	26.8%

2. *“The bond will fund career and technical education, and prepare students for careers in healthcare, engineering, skilled trades, and technology.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
30.0%	36.8%	66.9%	27.5%

3. *“Aging school buildings waste energy and cost more to maintain. By upgrading facilities, this bond will save money on operating costs in the long run.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
27.8%	38.7%	66.5%	29.4%

4. *“This measure will help fix and modernize aging school facilities across the district, giving all students access to 21st-century learning environments.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
26.5%	39.9%	66.4%	28.7%

5. *“Local businesses and employers need a skilled workforce. By preparing students for careers, this measure benefits the entire regional economy.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
29.2%	36.2%	65.4%	28.3%

6. *“All money raised by the measure will stay local to support our students. It can't be taken away by the State or used for other purposes.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
35.8%	29.5%	65.3%	29.9%

7. *“Colorado Springs District 11 hasn't asked voters to pass a school bond in over 20 years. This measure is long overdue to address critical facility needs.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
34.0%	31.3%	65.3%	28.7%

8. *“Voters are protected because the bond cannot be used for administrator salaries or operating expenses – only for facility construction and improvements.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
32.7%	31.5%	64.2%	30.6%

9. *“Without this investment, our schools will fall further behind, making it harder to attract and retain quality teachers and students.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
27.5%	32.8%	60.4%	33.5%

10. *“This measure will help right-size the district, reducing operating costs and improving educational quality by consolidating schools into modern facilities.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
20.6%	34.3%	54.9%	37.7%

11. *“School District 11 has a fiscally responsible plan for using bond funds, with strict financial accountability and independent audits.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
21.7%	33.1%	54.7%	39.4%

Key Finding: The strongest support arguments cluster in a narrow range (54.7% to 67.3% total convincing). Student safety (67.3%) and career/technical education (66.9%) lead, while the fiscally responsible plan argument (54.7%) and right-sizing the district (54.9%) are weakest. No support argument exceeds 67% total convincing, indicating a ceiling on persuasive impact.

Section 7: Opposition Argument Testing

Respondents were read a series of arguments against the bond measure and asked how convincing each was. Arguments are ranked by total convincing. (n=852)

1. *“The school board has not been transparent about long-term plans for school closures and consolidations. Voters should not approve this bond until there is a clear plan.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
42.8%	33.4%	76.2%	15.2%

2. *“District 11 already has a history of financial mismanagement. Before asking voters for \$750 million, the district should prove it can manage existing funds responsibly.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
44.3%	29.8%	74.1%	20.5%

3. *“There is no legally binding guarantee that bond funds will be spent as promised. The project list can change after voters approve the measure.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
43.5%	29.3%	72.8%	18.4%

4. *“This bond measure will increase property taxes by \$55 million per year. Working families, seniors on fixed incomes, and small businesses simply can’t afford this tax increase.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
40.3%	32.4%	72.8%	21.9%

5. *“Residents and businesses have been hit hard by inflation, high interest rates, and high gas prices. Now is not the time to raise taxes.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
36.2%	34.3%	70.5%	25.6%

6. *“School enrollment in District 11 has been declining. The district should right-size itself and reduce expenses rather than asking for money to build more facilities.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
28.6%	36.1%	64.7%	28.3%

7. *“A \$750 million bond will cost taxpayers over \$1.3 billion once interest is included. That’s too high a price for facilities upgrades that could be funded more affordably.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
35.5%	29.2%	64.7%	27.7%

8. *“The district has not made a convincing case that all of the proposed projects are truly necessary or represent the best use of taxpayer money.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
28.7%	33.2%	61.9%	29.0%

9. *“With so many competing needs in our community, spending \$750 million on school buildings is not the highest priority right now.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
21.6%	28.0%	49.6%	43.1%

10. “Private and charter schools have shown they can educate students more cost-effectively. We should redirect education funding to alternatives rather than prop up an expensive district bureaucracy.”

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
29.1%	18.5%	47.6%	47.6%

Key Finding: Opposition arguments are significantly stronger than support arguments. Board transparency (76.2%), financial mismanagement history (74.1%), and no legally binding guarantee (72.8%) are the most potent attacks. The top 5 opposition messages all exceed 70% total convincing, compared to the top support argument at only 67.3%. The campaign must proactively address trust and accountability concerns to protect the Yes vote.

Section 8: Respondent Connection to District 11

Respondents were asked about their personal connection to District 11 schools.

Question	Yes	No
Currently have children in D11 schools	21.2%	78.8%
Children attend private/charter schools	6.4%	93.6%
Children previously attended D11 schools	48.5%	51.5%

Key Finding: Only 21.2% of respondents currently have children in D11 schools, while 48.5% had children who previously attended. The majority of voters being asked to approve the bond do not have a direct current stake in the schools, reinforcing the importance of community-benefit messaging rather than parent-focused appeals.